



iPad quietly upgraded

Apple silently upgraded their iPad with a faster processor and brighter display without much fanfare. <http://digit.in/iPadwow>



3D printed skin?

University students in Spain have supposedly 3D printed fully functional human skin. <http://digit.in/3Dprntskin>

JUST THE TIP

IN-EAR HEADPHONE TEST

Siddharth Parwatay
editor@digit.in

With the kind of action seen in the in-ear headphone space over the past couple of years, it was conspicuously odd that we didn't do a comparison test for this category in so long. Yes we know, and we admit it – it's been long overdue. And finally we have it!

The road to this test however, wasn't an easy one. The IEM space has so many price categories, so many variants, and so many models in each category, we didn't know which category to choose. While it's true that the largest variety is found in the sub ₹1000 price range, we've noticed that consumers are beginning to get tired of extremely entry level headphones. The finer nuances of audio fidelity and

longevity take a beating in this price range.

Once you decide to move on from the CX180s and EMIs of the world, you start noticing aural subtleties. This was part of the reason we set our lower price range for this comparison at ₹2,000. At this price point you notice the first significant bump in sound quality. In terms of build, you see instances of quality materials being used – OFC cables, thermoplastic elastomers (TPE) sheathing, maybe a bit of kevlar, housings crafted out of high density plastic if not exotic metal. We believe consumers have begun to understand this. At least it feels that way going by the number of

requests we receive on a daily basis asking for recommendations in the ₹2000 and above price range.

We also observe that the incremental quality you get per unit of money invested steadily rises till about the ₹5000 mark after which it plateaus for a bit. Five grand is also the magic figure to which most budding audiophiles are willing to stick their necks out in the pursuit of quality.

That's exactly what our odd ensemble of assorted in-ear headphones represents: an eclectic selection of what lies in store for you in the world of audio appreciation. Of course it's also

a reflection of what brands managed to send to us. We asked for in-ear headphones in the range of ₹2000 to ₹5000 from all manner of manufacturers – from local brands like Tekfusion to Chinese ones like Brainwavz to even those across the seas like Sennheiser, Harman Kardon and everyone else in between. Some units like the Beyerdynamic Byron got stuck at customs. Others like JBL sadly didn't have any review units at hand.

In any case, the in-ear monitors we did end up with are some of the best in the market. So without further ado, let's get into the first of these devices! But first you

